

Apart from all these basics, which you should have no problem figuring out yourself, you should know that OneNote will also let you record audio and video notes with the help of a microphone and webcam. Just start recording by right-clicking on the OneNote icon in the task bar and choosing Start Recording Audio (or Video).

You can find such audio/video clips easily by searching for “video recording started” or “audio recording started”, which is the text that’s added by default when you record an audio/video note.

If you’re not really sure of where to put a thought, or if you haven’t yet made a Notebook for a project, but there’s something you need to record right away... all you need to do is press [Windows] + [N], and a Side Note popup called “Untitled Page...” is seen. Add your note here and then close it. It is automatically saved in the Unfiled Notes section of OneNote, which is just below your other Notebooks. You can always categorise it later.

The Coolest Ones

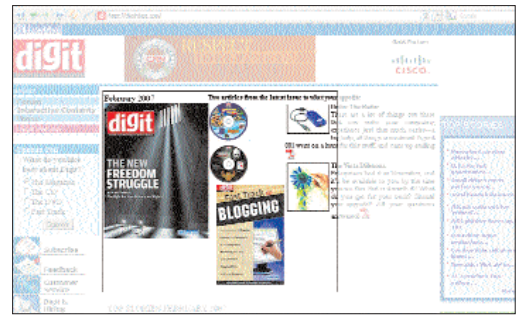
OneNote 2007 adds a lot of functionality for collaboration and teamwork, because no project is a one-man-show. When creating your Notebook, just select one of the Shared Notebook templates, or just choose Blank Notebook. When you click Next, you will see the options “I will use it on this computer”, “I will use it on multiple computers”, and “Multiple people will share this notebook”. Select the last option, and if you have a central file server that everyone in your team can access, choose the “On a server (SharePoint document library, network share, or other shared location)”, and specify the path to the folder on the server you wish to store this document on. If there’s no file server facility, just select “In a shared folder on this computer”. OneNote will automatically share the folder that the document resides in.

However, it is wise to make the share a dollar share if you’re going to be giving both read and write permissions, to protect your computer against viruses and the like. In both these steps, you get an option to create an e-mail to inform the rest of the team about the location of these files.

Instead of everyone working on one file, OneNote creates a local copy for all the people sharing the file and then keeps updating the changes people have made. What this means is that when out of office, team members will still have access to the Notebook, and changes will be updated when they’re back at work. VPNs and accessibility to mobile Internet means that you can hook up a laptop from virtually anywhere you are, and your Notebook can be set up to be updated online as well.

If you have multiple computers (most commonly a desktop and a laptop), you can get OneNote to synchronise your Notebooks to make sure all your computers that you work on are always up-to-date. When creating a Notebook, select “I will use it on multiple computers”, set a shared directory

Because OneNote integrates seamlessly with Outlook as well, if there’s a mail that relates to the project that your Notebook is organising, just drag it into OneNote



Take screen clippings from any application, or even of your desktop by pressing [Windows] + [S]

on one of them and then create it. When you want to synchronise, just go to File > Sync and all computers are updated.

You can build your own little Web site inside OneNote by using hyperlinks to point to other Notebooks, pages within a Notebook, Web URLs... anything! One interesting feature is that you can make text on one page into a hyperlink which points to another page, just select the text, right-click and choose the “Create Linked Page” option.

When it comes to making tables or creating shapes, easy-to-use toolbars will make your life easier. One notable upgrade to the 2003 version is the fact that the Lasso tool has been included. Though this is another feature meant for Tablet PC users, the Lasso tool is quite handy for those of us who use mice instead. Very often you will find your pages in your notebook quite cluttered with different notes (images, URLs, text, etc.). Instead of trying to select shapes or notes by clicking away to glory, you can use the Lasso tool to draw a selection around them, and then move them around as you please.

Privacy

Very often you might find yourself using OneNote alone—no team, no projects, no bosses—just you trying to get your life in order. You may want to store that joke you liked, or that ridiculous, raunchy forwarded picture that’s doing the rounds, and you can’t have your boss see these things of course, not even by mistake. All you have to do to prevent this is to password-protect your Notebook, or just a section of it. All you have to do is select the section, then go to File > Password Protect this Section.

If you were worried about storing sensitive data or valuable data such as credit card numbers, banking pins, etc., you don’t need to any more. OneNote features 3DES encryption, which is pretty much uncrackable. Just make sure your password is strong, because 3DES or not, setting your date of birth or your significant other’s pet name as the password is just plain silly!

Summing It Up

We’ve given you a very small overview of OneNote and its capabilities, and there’s tons more to learn. When it comes to organising your life, nothing we’ve seen before beats OneNote. It’s functional, simple and powerful, which is the perfect combination for success. Why keep a million sticky notes when you can store it all in OneNote! ■

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OneNote And Math

What’s 8752347 divided by 876235? This article is being typed in Microsoft Word, so to find the answer we have to go to Start > Run, type “calc”, enter the numbers again, and then find the answer. In OneNote, all you need to do is put an “equals” sign at the end of the phrase and press [Spacebar]. You can even do some geometry—just type $\tan(15)=$ or $\sin(60)$, find square roots, and much more.